Grade 3 ELA Question Bank

Topic 1: Reading Foundations and Fluency

150 multiple-choice questions • 50 Easy • 50 Medium • 50 Hard

Standards alignment: Common Core English Language Arts, Grade 3 Reading Foundational Skills (RF.3.3–RF.3.4). Questions cover decoding multisyllabic words, prefixes and suffixes, spelling-sound patterns, irregular words, syllables, and oral reading fluency.

Student instructions: Choose the best answer for each question. Each question has one correct answer.

Easy Questions (50)

1. Which word has the same beginning sound as “ship”?

A. shop
B. sip
C. chip
D. thin

2. Which word has the same beginning sound as “phone”?

A. photo
B. pan
C. van
D. then

3. Which word has the same beginning sound as “chair”?

A. share
B. cheer
C. care
D. there

4. Which word begins with the /th/ sound in “thumb”?

A. thin
B. tin
C. sin
D. win

5. Which word has the same ending sound as “wish”?

A. wash
B. fish
C. wide
D. win

6. Which word contains the long a sound as in “rain”?

A. ran
B. train
C. rug
D. red

7. Which word contains the long e sound as in “seed”?

A. said
B. sit
C. green
D. send

8. Which word contains the long i sound as in “kite”?

A. kit
B. pin
C. slide
D. slid

9. Which word contains the long o sound as in “home”?

A. hop
B. hope
C. hot
D. hum

10. Which word contains the long u sound as in “cube”?

A. cub
B. cute
C. cut
D. cup

11. What is the vowel team in “boat”?

A. oa
B. bo
C. at
D. bt

12. What is the vowel team in “cheese”?

A. ch
B. ee
C. es
D. se

13. Which word has the vowel team “ai”?

A. train
B. tree
C. truck
D. tray

14. Which word has the vowel team “ea” making the long e sound?

A. bread
B. head
C. beach
D. great

15. Which word has the vowel team “oi”?

A. coin
B. cone
C. can
D. cup

16. Which word has the vowel team “oy”?

A. boy
B. bay
C. buy
D. bee

17. Which word has the vowel team “ou” as in “cloud”?

A. could
B. cloud
C. clod
D. cold

18. Which word has the vowel team “ow” as in “cow”?

A. low
B. snow
C. brown
D. blow

19. Which word contains the r-controlled vowel “ar”?

A. star
B. stay
C. step

D. stir

20. Which word contains the r-controlled vowel “or”?

A. born
B. bean
C. burn
D. barn

21. Which word contains the r-controlled vowel “er”?

A. her
B. hat
C. hot
D. hit

22. Which word contains the r-controlled vowel “ir”?

A. bird
B. bad
C. bed
D. bud

23. Which word contains the r-controlled vowel “ur”?

A. turn
B. town
C. tan
D. ten

24. Which word has two syllables?

A. cat
B. sunset
C. dog
D. ship

25. Which word has three syllables?

A. happy
B. banana
C. rabbit
D. pencil

26. How many syllables are in “basket”?

A. 1
B. 2
C. 3
D. 4

27. How many syllables are in “computer”?

A. 1
B. 2
C. 3
D. 4

28. Which word is divided correctly into syllables?

A. pic-nic
B. p-icnic
C. pi-cnic
D. picn-ic

29. Which word has a prefix?

A. unhappy
B. garden
C. window
D. yellow

30. What does the prefix “un-” usually mean?
A. again
B. not or opposite of
C. before
D. full of

31. Which word has the suffix “-ful”?
A. careful
B. care
C. carpet
D. carry

32. What does the suffix “-less” mean in “fearless”?
A. full of
B. without
C. before
D. again

33. Which word has the prefix “re-”?
A. replay
B. player
C. playing
D. playful

34. What does “preview” mean?
A. to view before
B. to view again
C. to view slowly
D. to stop viewing

35. Which word has the suffix “-ness”?
A. kindness
B. kind
C. king
D. kite

36. Which word is spelled irregularly and should be remembered as a whole word?
A. said
B. sand
C. send
D. sound

37. Which word has a silent letter?
A. knock
B. kick
C. king
D. kit

38. In which word is the “gh” silent?
A. night
B. ghost
C. gift

D. giant

39. Which word has a consonant digraph?

A. shut
B. sun
C. sit
D. sad

40. Which word has a consonant blend?

A. stop
B. top
C. hop
D. up

41. Which word has the /j/ sound spelled “dge”?

A. bridge
B. bright
C. bring
D. brick

42. Which word has the /k/ sound spelled “ck”?

A. clock
B. coat
C. city
D. circle

43. Which word has the soft c sound /s/?

A. city
B. cat
C. cup
D. cut

44. Which word has the soft g sound /j/?

A. giant
B. game
C. gum
D. goat

45. Which word has the long a sound spelled “ay”?

A. play
B. plan
C. plum
D. plot

46. Which word has the long e sound spelled “y” at the end?

A. happy
B. hat
C. hot
D. hug

47. Which word has the long i sound spelled “igh”?

A. light
B. lit
C. let
D. lot

48. Which word has the long o sound spelled “oa”?

A. float
B. flat
C. flit
D. fleet

49. Which word has the long e sound spelled “ie”?

A. chief
B. chair
C. chore
D. cheap

50. What should a fluent reader do when reading a sentence aloud?

A. Read accurately and smoothly
B. Skip difficult words
C. Read every word as fast as possible
D. Ignore punctuation

Medium Questions (50)

51. Which word has the same vowel sound as “team”?

A. bread
B. dream
C. great
D. head

52. Which word has the same vowel sound as “touch”?

A. couch
B. rough
C. though
D. soup

53. Which word has the same vowel sound as “boil”?

A. soil
B. pool
C. pail
D. pole

54. Which word has the same vowel sound as “crowd”?

A. shown
B. cloud
C. could
D. clown

55. Which word has the same vowel sound as “learn”?

A. heart
B. fern
C. fear
D. fair

56. Which word has the same vowel sound as “burn”?

A. turn
B. barn
C. born
D. bean

57. Which word is divided correctly into syllables?

A. in-ter-est
B. int-er-est
C. inter-est
D. i-nterest

58. How many syllables are in “remembering”?

A. 2
B. 3
C. 4
D. 5

59. Which word has three syllables?

A. invent
B. important
C. market
D. sunshine

60. Which word has four syllables?

A. celebration
B. favorite
C. discover
D. tomorrow

61. What does the prefix “dis-” mean in “disagree”?
A. not or opposite of
B. again
C. under
D. before

62. What does the prefix “mis-” mean in “misread”?
A. wrongly
B. after
C. full of
D. small

63. What does the prefix “pre-” mean in “preheat”?
A. after
B. before
C. not
D. across

64. What does the suffix “-ment” do in “enjoyment”?
A. Makes a noun from a verb
B. Makes a verb from a noun
C. Means without
D. Means before

65. What does the suffix “-able” mean in “readable”?
A. able to be
B. without
C. again
D. full of

66. Which word means “to write again”?
A. rewrite
B. writer
C. writing
D. writable

67. Which word means “not safe”?
A. unsafe
B. safely
C. safety
D. safeness

68. Which word has a base word plus a suffix?
A. hopeful
B. open
C. hop
D. house

69. What is the base word in “carelessness”?
A. care
B. less
C. ness

D. careless

70. Which word has the suffix “-ly” changing an adjective into an adverb?

A. slowly
B. slow
C. slower
D. slowness

71. Which word contains a vowel-consonant-e pattern?

A. stripe
B. strip
C. step
D. stop

72. Which word has a vowel team making the long a sound?

A. eight
B. said
C. bread
D. head

73. Which word has “ough” making the /■/ sound?

A. though
B. rough
C. tough
D. cough

74. Which word has “ough” making the /f/ sound?

A. cough
B. though
C. through
D. dough

75. Which word has a silent consonant in the middle?

A. listen
B. letter
C. little
D. ladder

76. Which word contains a three-letter consonant blend?

A. splash
B. ship
C. shop
D. thin

77. Which word contains the consonant trigraph “tch”?

A. catch
B. cash
C. case
D. cast

78. Which word has “ph” making the /f/ sound?

A. graph
B. grass
C. great
D. glad

79. Which word has a soft g sound?

A. gentle
B. garden
C. gold
D. glove

80. Which word has a soft c sound?

A. cent
B. cap
C. cot
D. cup

81. Which word contains an r-controlled vowel with a different sound from the others?

A. star
B. farm
C. car
D. her

82. Which word has the same vowel sound as “heard”?

A. word
B. hard
C. herd
D. hire

83. Which word is an irregularly spelled word?

A. does
B. dogs
C. dolls
D. dents

84. Which word is most likely to be recognized by its unusual spelling?

A. once
B. pond
C. hand
D. sand

85. Which strategy helps decode an unfamiliar multisyllabic word?

A. Break it into syllables and read each part
B. Guess without looking
C. Skip it every time
D. Read only the first letter

86. A reader sees “disagreement.” Which parts help explain its meaning?

A. dis- + agree + -ment
B. dis + agreement only
C. agree + ment only
D. disagreement has no meaningful parts

87. Which word has a prefix and a suffix?

A. unhelpful
B. help
C. helper
D. helping

88. Which word is divided into syllables correctly?

A. fan-tas-tic
B. fant-ast-ic
C. fanta-stic

D. fa-nta-stic

89. Which word has a stressed first syllable?

A. pic-ture
B. re-lax
C. be-gin
D. a-bout

90. Which word has a stressed second syllable?

A. begin
B. garden
C. picnic
D. sunset

91. Which sentence is best read with a pause at the comma?

A. After lunch, we went outside.
B. After lunch we went outside
C. After, lunch we went outside.
D. After lunch we, went outside.

92. Why should a reader pay attention to punctuation when reading aloud?

A. It helps show pauses and expression
B. It makes every word louder
C. It tells the reader to skip words
D. It removes the need to understand

93. Which reading shows appropriate expression for a question?

A. “Where are you going?” with a questioning voice
B. Every sentence in a flat voice
C. Shouting every word
D. Whispering so softly no one can hear

94. What is the best way to improve reading accuracy?

A. Reread and correct words that were read incorrectly
B. Read faster without checking
C. Skip all long words
D. Ignore word endings

95. Which word has a suffix that means “full of”?

A. joyful
B. joyless
C. rejoice
D. enjoy

96. Which word means “to look over again”?

A. review
B. viewer
C. viewpoint
D. viewable

97. Which word contains a prefix meaning “under”?

A. submarine
B. preview
C. redo
D. unfair

98. Which word has a suffix meaning “one who”?

A. teacher
B. teach
C. teaching
D. teachable

99. Which word has a base word whose spelling changes when a suffix is added?

A. happiness
B. helpful
C. careless
D. kindness

100. What should a reader do when a word does not make sense after decoding it?

A. Reread and check whether the pronunciation fits the sentence
B. Keep reading the wrong word
C. Ignore the sentence meaning
D. Replace it with any word

Hard Questions (50)

101. Which word has the same vowel sound as “steak”?

A. break
B. bleak
C. speak
D. cheek

102. Which word has the same vowel sound as “flood”?

A. wood
B. food
C. good
D. mood

103. Which word has the same vowel sound as “bought”?

A. caught
B. boat
C. boot
D. bout

104. Which word has the same vowel sound as “measure” in its first syllable?

A. pleasure
B. meadow
C. meteor
D. meek

105. Which word contains a vowel pattern that can represent more than one sound?

A. bread
B. bead
C. team
D. seat

106. Which word has “ough” pronounced like /■f/?

A. rough
B. though
C. through
D. dough

107. Which word has “ough” pronounced like /■/?

A. dough
B. cough
C. rough
D. tough

108. Which word has “ough” pronounced like /oo/ in “through”?

A. through
B. thought
C. rough
D. enough

109. Which word is divided correctly into syllables?

A. con-fi-dence
B. conf-id-ence
C. co-nfid-ence
D. confi-dence

110. Which word is divided correctly into syllables?

A. ex-per-i-ment
B. expe-ri-ment
C. exper-i-ment
D. ex-perim-ent

111. Which word has a prefix meaning “across” or “beyond”?

A. transport
B. preview
C. misplace
D. unfair

112. In “unpredictable,” what does the prefix “un-” contribute?

A. It means not
B. It means again
C. It means before
D. It means under

113. Which analysis best explains the word “carelessness”?

A. care + -less + -ness
B. car + e + lessness
C. careless + -ful
D. care + -ness + -ful

114. What does the suffix “-tion” usually signal in a word such as “instruction”?

A. A noun naming an action or process
B. A word meaning not
C. A person who does something
D. A comparison of two things

115. Which word has both a prefix and a suffix?

A. disagreement
B. disagree
C. agreement
D. agree

116. Which word contains a root related to “spect,” meaning “look”?

A. inspect
B. insect
C. instruct
D. instead

117. Which word contains a root related to “port,” meaning “carry”?

A. portable
B. portion
C. portrait
D. portal

118. Which word’s spelling changes when “-y” is replaced before adding “-ness”?

A. lazy
B. slow
C. bright
D. kind

119. Which word forms its plural by changing the inside vowel rather than adding -s?

A. teeth
B. books
C. wishes

D. boxes

120. Which word has an unexpected spelling-sound relationship that readers often memorize?

A. colonel
B. cabin
C. cactus
D. comic

121. Which word has a silent letter combination at the beginning?

A. gnaw
B. glad
C. grab
D. glue

122. Which word contains a consonant sound represented by “ch” pronounced /k/?

A. chorus
B. chair
C. cheese
D. chase

123. Which word contains “x” representing two sounds /k/ + /s/?

A. box
B. exam
C. xylophone
D. exact

124. Which word has the /sh/ sound spelled “ti”?

A. nation
B. stationary
C. tiger
D. tiny

125. Which word has the /zh/ sound spelled “s”?

A. measure
B. message
C. mission
D. sun

126. Which word contains an unstressed vowel that is reduced to a schwa sound?

A. about
B. cat
C. ship
D. moon

127. Which word has the stress on the second syllable?

A. re-lax
B. gar-den
C. pic-ture
D. bas-ket

128. Which word has the stress on the third syllable?

A. com-pre-hend
B. win-dow
C. hap-py
D. pic-nic

129. Which pair differs mainly because of the stress pattern?

A. PREsent / preSENT
B. cat / cap
C. ship / shop
D. seat / seed

130. What is the best decoding strategy for “uncharacteristically”?

A. Identify meaningful parts and syllables, then blend them
B. Read only the first and last letters
C. Guess based on word length
D. Skip all prefixes

131. Which word contains a Greek combining form meaning “life”?

A. biology
B. geology
C. telephone
D. microscope

132. Which word contains a Latin root meaning “write”?

A. transcribe
B. transport
C. spectator
D. aquatic

133. Which word contains a prefix meaning “between”?

A. international
B. submarine
C. preview
D. misread

134. Which word contains a suffix meaning “able to be”?

A. visible
B. vision
C. visitor
D. visual

135. Which word’s pronunciation changes when it is used as a noun or a verb?

A. record
B. rabbit
C. window
D. pencil

136. Which sentence contains a word whose meaning depends on its pronunciation and stress?

A. I will present the present today.
B. The dog ran home.
C. We saw a bird.
D. She likes green grass.

137. A student reads “desert” as “dessert” in a sentence about a dry place. What should the student do?

A. Use the sentence meaning and stress pattern to reread the word correctly
B. Keep the pronunciation because the spelling is similar
C. Skip the word
D. Change the sentence topic

138. Which approach best supports accurate reading of a long unfamiliar word?

A. Look for prefixes, roots, suffixes, and syllable patterns
B. Read the last syllable only
C. Guess from the first letter

D. Ignore vowel patterns

139. Which reader demonstrates appropriate phrasing?

A. Groups words into meaningful phrases and pauses at punctuation
B. Pauses after every syllable
C. Reads without stopping at sentence endings
D. Speeds through commas and periods

140. What does prosody in oral reading include?

A. Expression, phrasing, and appropriate emphasis
B. Only the number of words read
C. Spelling every word aloud
D. Reading with no pauses

141. Why is repeated reading useful when a passage is at an appropriate level?

A. It can improve accuracy, rate, and expression
B. It changes the passage's spelling
C. It removes the need to understand
D. It guarantees every word is familiar

142. Which choice best describes a multisyllabic word?

A. A word with more than one syllable
B. A word with more than one letter
C. A word with a silent letter only
D. A word with no vowel sounds

143. Which word contains a closed syllable?

A. napkin
B. me
C. robot
D. music

144. Which word contains an open syllable?

A. robot
B. cat
C. desk
D. stamp

145. Which word contains a consonant-le final syllable?

A. candle
B. candy
C. canary
D. canal

146. Which word contains a vowel-r syllable pattern?

A. market
B. music
C. basic
D. pilot

147. Which word contains a vowel team in one syllable and a silent-e pattern in another?

A. daytime
B. basket
C. rabbit
D. sunset

148. Which word's prefix changes the meaning of the base word without changing its part of speech?

A. rebuild
B. builder
C. building
D. beautiful

149. Which statement best describes a skilled Grade 3 reader decoding a difficult word?

A. They use spelling patterns and word parts, then check whether the word makes sense
B. They guess quickly and never reread
C. They focus only on the first letter
D. They ignore meaning while reading

150. Which word contains a prefix meaning “again”?

A. reappear
B. disappear
C. misplace
D. unusual

Answer Key

Answers are listed by question number.

1. A	2. A	3. B
4. A	5. B	6. B
7. C	8. C	9. B
10. B	11. A	12. B
13. A	14. C	15. A
16. A	17. B	18. C
19. A	20. A	21. A
22. A	23. A	24. B
25. B	26. B	27. C
28. A	29. A	30. B
31. A	32. B	33. A
34. A	35. A	36. A
37. A	38. A	39. A
40. A	41. A	42. A
43. A	44. A	45. A
46. A	47. A	48. A
49. A	50. A	51. B
52. B	53. A	54. B
55. B	56. A	57. A
58. B	59. B	60. A
61. A	62. A	63. B
64. A	65. A	66. A
67. A	68. A	69. A
70. A	71. A	72. A
73. A	74. A	75. A
76. A	77. A	78. A
79. A	80. A	81. D
82. C	83. A	84. A
85. A	86. A	87. A
88. A	89. A	90. A
91. A	92. A	93. A
94. A	95. A	96. A
97. A	98. A	99. A
100. A	101. A	102. C
103. A	104. A	105. A
106. A	107. A	108. A
109. A	110. A	111. A

112. A
113. A
114. A
115. A
116. A
117. A
118. A
119. A
120. A
121. A
122. A
123. A
124. A
125. A
126. A
127. A
128. A
129. A
130. A
131. A
132. A
133. A
134. A
135. A
136. A
137. A
138. A
139. A
140. A
141. A
142. A
143. A
144. A
145. A
146. A
147. A
148. A
149. A
150. A